

**UNIVERSIDAD DE LAS FUERZAS ARMADAS ESPE
COMPUTER SCIENCE DEPARTMENT
ADVANCED WEB DEVELOPMENT - 27819
HOMEWORK # - ANALYSIS OF A WEB APP**

Web Application Analysis – Guardería Rayuela

This analysis evaluates the graphical user interface of a daycare website using core UI and UX principles such as user-centered design, navigation, layout, and interaction patterns. The website is primarily informational and targets parents seeking childcare services. The objective of this critique is to identify how effectively the interface communicates information, supports user goals, and highlights areas for usability improvement.

1. Complex Data Display (Patterns & Techniques)

The daycare website presents low to moderate complexity data, mainly informational rather than transactional.

Core data includes programs offered, age groups, schedules, facilities, and contact information.

Data is presented mostly through text blocks and image-supported sections, rather than structured tables.

The system uses a linear and tabular mental model, where users scroll vertically to consume information.

Techniques used:

- **Section-based content grouping instead of explicit data tables.**
- **Visual separation using titles, images, and whitespace.**
- **No advanced data visualization (charts, dashboards, or tables).**

Limitations:

- Schedules, age ranges, and services could benefit from tabular layouts for faster scanning.
- No filtering or comparison mechanisms for programs or services.
- Information is static, with no interactive data exploration.

2. Action Command Mechanisms

User actions are minimal and focused on information access rather than data manipulation.

Primary actions include:

- Navigate between sections (Home, About, Services, Contact).
- Initiate contact via phone number or contact page.
- View image galleries.

Patterns used:

- Visible commands through menu links and buttons.
- Standard hyperlink-based navigation.
- No invisible actions (keyboard shortcuts, drag-and-drop).

Usability observations:

- Calls to action (e.g., “Contact”, “Schedule a Visit”) are present but not visually dominant.

- No confirmation, feedback, or progress indicators since actions are non-transactional.
- The system could benefit from stronger action affordances (contrast, size, placement).

3. Layout Model Patterns

The website follows a classic informational website layout.

Layout structure:

- Top header with logo and horizontal navigation.
- Central content column with stacked sections.
- Footer with contact and institutional information.

Patterns identified:

- Center Stage: main message and value proposition are placed at the top of the homepage.
- Titled Sections: each content block has a clear heading.
- Responsive layout: adapts to mobile and tablet screens.

Issues:

- Long vertical scrolling due to full-page content blocks.

- **Lack of progressive disclosure (all information is shown at once).**
- **Accordion panels or tabbed sections could reduce cognitive load.**

4. Navigation / “You Are Here” Patterns

Navigation is simple and shallow, appropriate for first-time users.

Navigation model:

- **Flat navigation with a small number of top-level pages.**
- **No deep hierarchy or nested navigation.**

Patterns used:

- **Clear menu labels.**
- **Consistent navigation bar across pages.**

Missing patterns:

- **No breadcrumbs to indicate location within the site.**
- **No visual indicator highlighting the current page.**
- **No internal navigation aids within long pages.**

Impact:

- **Users can move easily between main sections.**
- **However, orientation inside longer pages could be improved.**

5. Design Patterns in the Interface

The site applies a small set of well-known UI patterns.

Patterns observed:

- **Landing Page Pattern:** homepage summarizes all key information.
- **List of Information Sections:** services and programs presented sequentially.
- **Image + Text Pairing:** reinforces emotional trust and context.

Patterns not used:

- **No dashboards.**
- **No master-detail views.**
- **No wizard or step-based processes (e.g., enrollment).**

6. User Research & UX Implications

Primary user groups:

- **Parents seeking daycare services.**
- **Parents comparing childcare options.**
- **First-time visitors unfamiliar with the institution.**

Usability strengths:

- **Simple language and familiar structure.**
- **Low learning curve.**
- **No technical knowledge required.**
- **Emotional design through imagery builds trust.**

Usability challenges:

- **Lack of quick-scan summaries (icons, bullet highlights).**
- **No guided path for enrollment or inquiry.**
- **Limited feedback or reassurance during contact actions.**

Potential user research insights:

- **Parents value safety, trust, and clarity → could be reinforced with visual cues.**
- **First-time users would benefit from clear primary CTAs.**

- Repeat visitors would benefit from shortcuts (quick contact buttons).

7. Conclusion

The daycare website provides a clear and accessible informational interface focused on trust, simplicity, and institutional presentation. It successfully communicates essential information and is easy to navigate for non-technical users, especially parents.

However, the interface prioritizes static information over interaction. The lack of structured data presentation, strong call-to-action elements, and orientation cues limits efficiency for users who want to act quickly (e.g., enroll or request information).

Overall, the website favors clarity over functionality. By adding clearer action emphasis, better data structuring, and basic navigation cues, the user experience could be significantly improved without increasing complexity.